Liam L. Larmark



Rapist Nigger

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CHAPTER 1

The day a rapist was born

On the streets of Puerto Madero roamed a young man who appeared to be a bit impaired. Stumbling across the streets, onlookers could only assume that he was going home. Some time ago, he had tried to drink his problems away, but before that, he had spent hours planning what he would say to his crush, only to get crushed by her rejection.

"Next year will be different; next year I won't be alone," he stuttered.

But life had other plans for him; it was only a matter of minutes before New Year's Eve became New Year's Day.

"Help!" screamed a young woman. He wandered in the direction of the voice, assuming it was merely a lover's quarrel, but nothing could prepare him for the truth. Before his eyes stood a seven-foot-tall dark figure. He couldn't make out what it was doing, but he heard a strange noise and in his mind, he knew what was going on.

"Stop it!" he shouted.

"What are you doing here, boy?" it replied.

Struggling to regain his composure, he shouted, "I—I said stop it!"

"What is your name, boy?" it said, ignoring his demand.

"Rider," he muttered.

It stopped what it was doing and dashed towards him. The stranger he had saved could only run to safety. What else could she do? Rider could not run; his body was paralyzed. He could not scream; his mouth was forcefully covered. All he could do was think. The dark stranger's tongue twisted inhumanly into his ears, and he could feel it sucking on his brain and soul. It went on for what felt like hours, while the sky was painted in beautiful, loud colors signifying the end of a year.

The next day, he woke up naked on the same bridge, remembering only what had happened to him that night. Ever since that day, he would paint his body black and his lips red, reenacting what had occurred, thus the world came to know him as rapistnigger.

CHAPTER 2

Geo the last hero

Within the police precinct of Puerto Madero, George Gagnon was battling a case which fellow officers had dismissed.
“Geo, go home. Do you really think tomorrow will be the end of the world?”
“No, I'm just finishing work. And don't call me that; I’ll go home soon.”
“Really? I pegged you as one of those crazy Y2K preppers.”
“Can you leave me alone?”
“You shouldn't damage your only good eye on that computer, Geo.”
The last time his wife was at the office, she had accidentally called him by his pet name, Geo. Ever since then, his coworkers used it to tease him. George was very strict; he’d always say, “Home is home, and work is work. I’d prefer to keep them separate.” His coworkers thought of him as a cold but hard-working guy who was promoted to a commissioner officer within two years, though others knew him as a compassionate person.
Geo started nodding off and finally fell asleep. He dreamt of his time back in Canada, how he met his wife, and how they moved to Argentina.
“Geo!” His coworker woke him up from a marvelous dream of the past, so starkly in comparison to his current awful life.
“Yeah, yeah, I’ll get home.”
He walked out to the parking lot, where his car failed him.
“Not again.”
He would have taken a cab back home, but he had lost his wallet earlier that day, so he had to walk. Even though he was physically fit, he lived five miles away. Halfway through his journey, he felt tired, so he stopped at a bench to rest.
"Help!" squealed the voice of a young woman, pulling his mind back to his wife.
“Was this how she felt when she was assaulted?” he thought.
Following the voice, he ran through the back streets of Puerto Madero, looking for the stranger's voice again, which led to a bridge. Before his eyes strode a seven-foot-tall dark, inhuman figure, its hands twisted around the lady's arm, which seemed to paralyze her. To him, it looked like a monster. He wanted to stop it, but his legs couldn't move. Geo tried to form the word "stop," but

fear froze his voice. In the end, all he could do was watch. Seconds felt like days, and then a voice pierced through the silence.
"Stop it!" it shouted.
"What are you doing here, boy?" it whispered, though the sound cut sharply through the air.
"I—I said stop it!"
"What is your name, boy?"
Geo struggled to understand the boy's muttering, but before he could figure out what he said, the figure launched toward the boy, pinning him to the ground. The lady ran past Geo as though he wasn't even there. What felt like hours passed, and two thousand fireworks exploded into the night sky for the new year, which snapped Geo awake.
"I became a police officer to save lives."
He pulled out a 9×19mm Parabellum semi-automatic pistol and fired off a barrage of bullets. It sent the figure back to the bridge's railings. He fired off more rounds, emptying his pistol into the figure until it capsized into the water. He walked over to check on the boy.
"This kid looks like he's just turned 20. Where are his clothes? I can't get him back to the station like this."
"Do you think you're a hero? This boy thought the same look at him now."
The figure appeared behind Geo, gripping his neck with one hand, which paralyzed his body. He felt a strange, soft, wet object slithering its way into his ears and a hard object pressed against his backside. Before the figure could act out its sick wishes, it vanished.
"It came from here."
A group of teens appeared, one carrying a 35mm disposable camera and recording as he walked. Geo quickly ran to shield them from the gruesome scene before him. They bombarded him with questions; although his head was pounding, he tried to move them away from the kid's naked body while answering.
Thinking on his feet, he lied, "Someone tried to rob me. It was only self-defense."
"Is the gun legal?"
"Yes, I am a police officer."
"Why did you shoot him so much?"
"I was only trying to scare him off, but he was persistent."
"How could he rob an officer in Puerto Madero of all places? Is he stupid?"
"Do I look like an officer?"
"Why did you let him get away?"
"Well..."
"What did he look like?"

They were obviously intoxicated, so Geo walked with them to the nearest crowd, and then they parted ways. Away from the crowd, Geo's mind wandered back to the shadow figure.
“Even though I emptied my gun into him, he's still alive. Did I miss? Was that even a human?”
The more he walked, the less he thought of the monster, and his thoughts shifted back to his wife. This was the longest he had ever left her unsupervised; surely her caretaker had left to spend time with her family. Geo missed his sweet, caring wife and longed to hear her call him by that nickname she gave him. So all he could do was think about the past.
Ten years ago, along the coastal shores of Canada, George spent his summer vacation studying alone. His friends invited him to study with them, but he seemed to be the only one actually working. His friends were all playing while he was struggling to read. The noise was unbearable, and although he was under the beach cabanas, the bright sun made it even more difficult for his weak eyes to read, so he held the book closer.
"Nerd."
He ignored the voice and continued to read with his book three inches away from his face, but the voice persisted.
"Hiding won't make me go away. Are you scared of pretty ladies, or do you hide from everyone?”
"I can't see well."
"Is that why you always sit in front? Maybe you should buy glasses like normal people."
George lowered his book. "Maybe if I was 12 like you, I could have asked mommy or daddy to buy some for me, but glasses are expensive."
"I am 16, asshole."
"What's the difference, pretty lady? You're a child."
"At least I have friends."
"I have friends."
George stood up to prove his point, looking for the friend who had invited him, only to realize they had left and forgotten about him. Once he noticed, he sat back down, flustered. The girl began to laugh.
“I'm Jameria. What about you?”
“George.”
“Can I call you Geo? I'm not good at remembering names.”
“No, you can’t. I'd rather you not call me anything. In fact, I would be happy if we never talked again.”
“Asshole. This is why you have no friends.”
“Where are your friends?”
“How about you become my first friend?”

Summer vacation flew by quickly, and Jameria kept calling George, though he tried to ignore her. Soon, the new semester started.

“Geo, hey!”

“How did you get my landline? And when did you get into the same college as me?”

“I attended the University of Toronto before you. This is my last semester.”

“How did a 12-year-old get into college?”

“Asshole, we are around the same age! Why do you always act like you're older?”

“I’m 20. People will start making up rumors if you keep following me around campus.”

“What rumors? No one pays attention to you anyway. Look at this.”

She handed him a Polaroid photo of a group of teens at the beach.

“You have friends?”

“You're the only one who doesn't, Geo. We went to high school together; I was trying to invite you, but…”

“But I don't have the time.”

“I get that, but friends are important too.”

George's frustration with Jameria grew, and their one-sided friendship continued. Jameria would follow him everywhere, and others started using his new nickname.

The semester was long and difficult. George didn't look forward to his results, but there was a sunny beam of light seemed to follow him, and his face wore an uncharacteristic smile. As he walked to the notice boards, his unfamiliar smile, juxtaposed with his usual awful mood, made him look like a creep to the classmates who noticed. Jameria passed George without saying a word; when with friends, her words were short, which made George curious, but regardless, he was happy to be away from her. Students surrounded the notice board, looking for their grades, while some were only there to compare results. Jameria held her friend's hand and navigated through the crowd while George stood at the back, waiting for the crowd to pass.

Jameria knew that this was the last time she would see George, so she waited. She wanted to know if Geo would say anything to her or if he even remembered. Unfortunately, she was unprepared for the truth; as she left the notice board with her friend, talking about what they would do after school, her eyes glanced at Geo. They never spoke that day, nor any day after.

As the crowd died down, he checked his GPA. It was 4.49 a mark away from perfect, but he had gotten used to it. He quickly scanned the notice board to see who did better; one student had a GPA of 1.2, and the average was 2.9, but the only one who got higher was Jameria.

“George? How are you hanging in there?” a familiar voice asked.

George looked up. It was his one friend or the closest thing he had to one Damian, a giant. He had stood at six feet at the age of 15, and as they grew up, Damian continued to grow until he was now

seven feet tall. His height made it easy to get attention from women, contrasting with George, who was very short.
“I'm well. Did you check your GPA?”
“Nah, is it even that important? You need to loosen up, man.”
“It is.”
“Whatever, man. Me and a couple of guys are going to have a frat party. Wanna come?”
“I wouldn't be able to come.”
“There will be loads of women with massive... well, personalities and GPAs."
“I'm sorry, but I've got to study before the next semester.”
“Do you like the ones with smaller personalities? You seem like you're more into that anyway.”
“What do you mean?”
“That girl you were always with. How do you know her anyway?”
“Last semester the beach you left me at, Damian.”
“Sorry, man, but it was the only way to get you out of the books.”
“Maybe you wouldn't have gotten a 1.2 if you studied.”
“That high? I'm always improving!"
“1.2 isn't good.”
“Whatever, man.”
Damian could tell that something had changed George, and he thought to himself, "Was it that girl? Regardless, I hate that pretentious twat. I'm his only friend, yet he keeps lecturing me."
The rest of Geo's school life had become uneventful, but he had started to miss Jameria's pestering. He strived to do better than her in the future, even though, though only 16, she was ahead of her class and the valedictorian of that year's graduating class. Each year that passed, Geo's opinion of her changed; initially, he thought she was just a rich "airhead" thrust into college by her parents, but she was hard-working and still made time to develop her personal life, unlike George.
As George navigated his school life, he focused not only on studying but also on his social life. His cold exterior eroded, and he became a friendlier person. His peers realized this change and he gained friends, but Damian slowly distanced himself from him. Jameria had become George's hero; if it wasn't for her, he wouldn't have understood the importance of having friends.
George's final semester was ending, and grades were posted to the notice board. He managed to raise his GPA to 4.5, but more importantly, he had friends. Geo didn't care to check the notice board right away, so he slept in the college's dorms a bit longer while his classmates all rushed to see who would be graduating. George couldn't sleep; it was 8:00 AM, and he wasn't used to sleeping past seven, so he thought about his life and the friends he had made because of that girl.
Eventually, he got excited to see what his hard work had allowed him to accomplish. At the notice board, kids were packed together as usual, but they made way for George, pointing and whispering.

Surely my grades can't be that good, right? Jameria was far more popular, and she got the same grade. Maybe I did poorly?
“Creep!” one shouted.
“How didn't I know what he was?”
“Well, he always looked at me weirdly."
“RAPIST!”
At the top of the notice board, the word "RAPIST" was spelled out using a blood-red marker. Underneath it was a picture of George at the beach with Jameria, pictures of women's undergarments, a photo of Jameria and her friends in bikinis, and various vulgar notes all connected with pins and red yarn. One note claimed that George had assaulted and then blackmailed a 16-year-old to be his friend. Another claimed that he had sneaked into the women's washroom and stolen undergarments. One yarn led to another notice board with Jameria’s photo and a number of women's garments in his dorm; the notice board had been transformed into an evidence board of false accusations. He reached out to remove the slander, but another student slapped his hand away. They all stood between him and the board; to them, this was justice.
“We aren't leaving until a lecturer sees this and the school launches an investigation.”
“Where are the lecturers?”
George ran back to the dorms, where he bumped into a familiar tall figure.
“Damian!”
“Don’t talk to me.”
“Did you see the notice board?”
"Didn't I say don't talk to me?”
“You know I didn't do any of that, don't you?”
“I know.”
“Then why?”
“I don't care if you did, bro. Just don't talk to me, ok?”
One thought raced through his mind: What if it was all Damian? But why? He immediately pushed the thought out of his mind; after all, Damian was a true friend. Similarly to Jameria, he had always tried to pull Geo out of his shell and into civil society. When he returned to his dorm, he lay awake, unable to get over the ordeal. He never got to see his grades, nor did he get any rest.
The next day, he had almost forgotten about the incident after all, he was used to being alone but the cold, indifferent eyes his classmates once had were incomparable to the pure disdain they now carried. He tried going to the school's main office, but the students' eyes felt like arrows raining down to pierce their enemy. He was defenseless and alone, so he delayed it and went to the notice board to see his grades.

There was a petition to get him suspended, pinned with over 50 signatures. He had gained the highest achievable score, but what was the point? He had nobody to celebrate with, and nobody cared for him. Next to the notice board was the office. During the school year, it was lively, but as the semester came to a close, it had died down.

He knocked on the door, and no one answered.

“Hello?”

“Come in.”

“Is the school aware of what happened yesterday?”

“Yes, we have contacted the police, but we can’t suspend or arrest anyone without solid proof. If you would like to make a report, please fill out this form. We are investigating alongside the police.”

Geo left without saying another word. The school has labeled me a rapist, he thought. He returned to his room and started packing.

Will I graduate?

Then suddenly, there was a knock at the door. It was Jameria; she had matured.

She explained that the school had called, prying for information on him.

“It's weird, right? I tried asking them why, but they kept asking me stupid questions. What's up?”

Geo said nothing at first, but Jameria's persuasiveness and people skills had grown. She began to walk him through her life moving from an accountant to a fashion designer to a model. She had built her own successful business selling clothes and talked about how she had traveled across the world.

“Argentina is nice, and I was actually thinking…”

“Why?”

“Why what?”

“Why do you keep talking?”

“If you told me what happened, I'd leave.”

He explained what happened. She apologized for everything and blamed herself.

“I know you hated me, but you're not going to have to see me again because I'm moving to Argentina.”

“I don't hate you.”

“If you're ever looking for a job after school, call.”

She gave him a business card and walked away. The moment she left, he threw it away. The school investigation eventually revealed that George was innocent and forbade students from using the notice board for anything other than club activities. Geo achieved the highest GPA amongst the students, but because of the incident, the school decided it would be best to declare another student as the valedictorian. The newspapers covered the story, and the school's silence on the

matter caused even George's parents to limit their communications with him. In the end, George graduated not as the valedictorian he desired to be, but as a rapist in the eyes of his peers.
After college, George hopped from job to job, but the title of a rapist followed him everywhere. He moved to Argentina in 1994 to escape this life, but the job-hopping persisted. A year later, he settled into a permanent job where he met a familiar face: Jameria was the accountant of the company he worked for. She explained that at 21, it was hard to work for her former modeling agency and that her business had failed. They reconnected, and Geo explained that the school had died without her lively energy when she left, admitting he had started to miss her. George began to look at her less like a child and more the way a man looks at a woman. His work was very lucrative, and he could even afford to buy a Bentley Continental T.
Jameria confessed that she had always looked up to Geo's determination, and the two would later marry. Regardless of how often they tried, they were unable to bear children, so they adopted a 10-year-old boy named Ray. Geo became a police officer, and Jameria stayed home to look after their adopted son.
"Hey, Jameria, I am home."
"I can make you dinner if you're hungry."
"No, I can make dinner myself. Where is Ray?"
"He's still at school, dear."
"I hope he's making friends."
"He takes after me more, so he should be fine."
"I do hope so."
Ever since Ray had left the orphanage, he had lost his childlike innocence and the bright smile that used to light up a room. He had been the oldest at the orphanage, and after watching his friends all leave, he had learned how to behave around adults if he wanted to get adopted. Ray wasn't their biological child, but to Jameria, there was no difference; she was patient with him and taught him how to be a kid. He was cold and distant, only calling his adoptive parents by their names, but slowly he started to call Jameria "Mother."
The cathode-ray tube television made it difficult for anyone to hear the landline, but the ringing continued. After Geo was done making dinner for himself, he left the kitchen and answered the phone.
"Can you turn the TV down? I can't hear the phone."
"Sorry!"
"Hello?"
"Jameria?"
"It's for you, dear," he said while clamping his hand over the bottom of the phone.
"What?" she replied while twisting the television volume knob up.

“Turn the TV down!”
She lowered the knob to say, “Look at the time. Ray must be done with school.”
Jameria left to get Ray, and Geo got stuck in an awkward conversation. Jameria’s mother insisted that she had been calling all day and that he must have done something to the landline to steal her daughter away. Their relationship was strained; she blamed George for the failure of her daughter's business and formerly successful life. She pressed George for details on his job and what car he was driving, and demanded to see Ray. Geo only answered using "Yes, ma'am" he was afraid of the harsh personality built by years of strict teaching. She hung up after berating him, and a little while later, Jameria returned.
“Why didn't you tell me?”
“Shh, not in front of the kid, dear.”
“You dumped her onto me, though.”
“How would I know it was my mother?”
“She said she was calling all day. I should have known, when do you even watch television? You owe me, okay?”
“Okie dokie.”
Ray, usually quiet, said, “Mom, I'm hungry.”
“How about you let Dad make his famous...”
“Mister George isn't good at cooking.”
“Haha! True, Mister George isn't good at many things. I'll make dinner.”
Jameria went to the kitchen. Under the microwave stand was a spot that she swore wasn't there when she last used the kitchen. The white marble countertop looked yellow beneath the incandescent bulbs. Every item seemed to have been moved, placed where they shouldn't be: the black pepper was in the fridge, and the ketchup sat too close to the mustard. She strapped her cleaning apron around her waist and used spandex gloves along with a cleaning brush to decontaminate her kitchen. After cleaning, Jameria prepared a list of items they would need and prepared to leave, but her husband stopped her before she could go.
“Done so fast?”
“No, you used up all my ingredients.”
“You could have asked me for what you needed”
“No, but you owe me, okay?”
“Sure, sure, whatever.”
George kissed Jameria's forehead as she left, with the TV still playing in the background.
“Dad, when will Mom be back?”
“She should be back soon.”
He finally called me father, George thought, feeling happy. If only that could last for a while longer.

Hours passed, and Jameria wasn't home. George sent Ray to bed, though he was worried. What could he do? At 12:00 AM, the landline rang.
“Who could be calling this late?”
It was the police precinct of Puerto Madero.
“George, come to the station now.”
“This late?”
“It's your wife.”
George crept through the house quickly, grabbed his keys, and bolted to the station in his Bentley Continental T. He blew through every stoplight, focused only on getting to the station. When he arrived, they led him to the investigation room. Looking through the two-way mirror, he saw a woman wearing only a coat and handcuffed to a chair. A biker's helmet sat on her head, and the room was childproofed.
“What is this?”
“I am as clueless as you, George. All she said was that her head hurt after smashing it into the table. She hasn't said anything since. Mr. A—”
“Who is this?”
“It's your wife.”
George burst through the door and demanded the detective leave, then removed the helmet from her. The helmet fell to the ground; her face was covered in blood, and her left eyelid was swollen purple. Countless scenarios played in his mind. Did my coworkers do this just because of bad driving? He should have let her go. He blamed himself, but he couldn't get over her blank eyes. He tried talking to her, but she didn't respond. He took off the handcuffs, and before he could sit on the opposite side, she lunged at him. She overpowered him and dug her nails into his right eye. The investigators rushed in to restrain her and explained what had happened.
“An hour ago, a man called and said he was being chased by a ghost. Of course, we assumed it was a prank call.”
“Get to the point.”
“Your wife attacked a family, injuring the mother and daughter. We aren't sure what they did or why she was naked, but the family says she came out of nowhere. Thankfully they are alive hopefully, they don’t press charges.”
George, clenching his right eye, looked over at his wife's blank expression.
“What happened?” The wind carried his voice, but nothing was returned.
What followed was a weary battle in court. George hired the best lawyer and poured all his resources into resolving the issue quickly before the media got involved, knowing how brutal investigative journalism could be. He sold his car and his house, and used every dollar he and his wife had saved to send Ray to college. The court settled on 115,000 pesos, or Jameria would be sent

to a psychiatric hospital. He borrowed money from the bank to pay it off, but his wife never returned to her cheerful self again.

When his wife came home, the first thing she did was lunge toward Ray. He extended his arms to embrace his mother, but how could he have known she was trying to attack? The incident left a permanent scar on the boy's already troubled heart. Maybe it was a lack of proper diet, but George was able to restrain her. The next day, he began to pack Ray's belongings.

“Why didn't Mom wake me up for school?”

“You're going away for a while.”

“Do y'all hate me?”

“No! But you can't live with Mommy or Daddy anymore.”

“Are you sending me back to the orphanage?”

“No, you're going to live with your grandmother.”

“But I don't like her, and she doesn't like me.”

“Your grandmother loves you, Ray.”

“Was it something I did?”

George hugged the boy and explained that he had to be strong from now on. He told him that he wasn't sure if he would ever be able to come home, insisting that it was all his fault and that neither his mother nor Ray had done anything wrong. When Jameria’s mother arrived, she said nothing; she had already poured her heart out over the phone. She hated George for ruining her daughter's successful life, but now she despised him for making her "disabled."

“She must have gone crazy serving your lazy ass all the time,” she had said before hanging up.

George spent weeks looking for ways to cure his wife. He swapped the direction of a spare bedroom handle and locked her in for her safety. She would scratch and bang her head against the walls; even though the walls were padded and the floor was made of chestnut wood, the noise echoed through the dead house. One of the detectives recommended a therapist named Agustín, though counseling centers were halfway across the country. George would have to wait for his annual visit to Puerto Madero or pay for him to come out. Unable to find a closer therapist or wait any longer, he borrowed more money.

When the therapist arrived, he was appalled by the state of Jameria's living quarters. The wall padding was punctured, and the floorboards were raised in every direction like a broken Piano. Jameria’s straitjacket barely contained her fidgeting, and she wore an animal cone. "Fitting," he thought, standing on all four limbs as she was indistinguishable from a feral animal.

George explained what had happened to her, and the therapist tried talking to her. Afterward, he claimed he was unable to do anything, though he assumed there was severe damage to her brain and recommended a neurosurgeon named Mateo. He also suggested heavy doses of olanzapine and risperidone, diagnosing Jameria with Anorexia Nervosa, Cyclothymic Disorder,

Depersonalization-Derealization Disorder, Disruptive Mood Dysregulation Disorder, Exhibitionistic Disorder, Generalized Anxiety Disorder, Insomnia Disorder, Intermittent Explosive Disorder, Narcolepsy, Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder, and Trichotillomania.

George went to Dr. Mateo's office, which luckily was close. He explained what had happened, then carried Jameria into the testing room.

“I’ve seen tumor resections, shrapnel, and machete wounds, but this? I'm not sure what you and your wife are into, but it looks like someone licked the temporal lobe.”

“What do you mean?”

“Honestly, I'm not sure if it would do anything to her, but it looks like someone stuck their tongue up her ear. There is no physical damage done to her brain, though.”

“Why do you say that?”

"Looking at these chemical markers. There isn't any structural damage whatsoever, but to put it bluntly: I found saliva in her brain."

“We've already sent a sample down to pathology for an enzyme analysis. With the moisture on her brain, we should be able to track whose saliva it is. That being said, this has nothing to do with her deteriorated state. I think it's probably a bit simpler. Go to any clinic and have them examine her body.”

“What happened to her?”

“She was assaulted. This isn't the second time I've had a person lose their mind after being raped.”

The medication helped to calm Jameria, but she couldn't eat by herself or even walk, her eyes lifeless as if she had regressed to an infant. Geo loved his wife regardless. Ray never visited, but while he was at work, George hired a caretaker for her. If he ever missed a dose of her medication, she would go into a manic rage, and she never slept through the night. Every night, he cried and prayed, "Please wake up," but she never did.

The rowdy shouts of “¡Feliz Año!” and the chaotic clinking of champagne glasses from the loudest neighbors on the block tore him away from the past. He was just four blocks away now, so he picked up the pace. His house stood desolate on a dead-end hill; the lights were off, and the gloomy atmosphere strongly contrasted with his neighbors.

Knock, knock...

“I’m home,” he said, knowing no one would answer back, but it was just a habit. He wrapped his hand around the handle, and the door slowly cracked to the world.

“That's odd, but who would want anything from my rundown shack?”

“It must have been that caretaker. Caretaker? Money-taker is more like it.”

Geo felt around to find the power switch, but even after flipping it, the pitch-black darkness didn't lift. He tried to navigate carefully around the house, but bumped into everything. The soft couch felt a bit lower; he even tipped a vase over.

“Hopefully, she's still asleep.”
He made it past the living room and managed to find the breaker box in the hallway. He flipped one switch, and the fridge started humming in the kitchen. Another switch turned on the fans, but he regretted touching the last one: the room lit up, and as Geo's eye adjusted to the light he fell to his knees.
An electrical cord tied the body of the caretaker to an outlet. She was bruised and burned, the wire seemingly intertwined into her flesh. She lay in a massive pool of blood, but it was not her own. George's bloody footprints were scattered across the ground.
Above the caretaker hung the body of Geo's wife, lifeless body dangled from the ceiling, tied securely with polypropylene rope. A knife was plunged into her throat, and the blood had turned her white dress red. George walked to his wife, her red eyes staring into his soul.
“Maybe she's just sleeping,” he muttered.
He slowly untied her, then pulled the knife from her neck. He gently shook her body in the half-dry blood.
“Wake up, dear.”
He shook her violently and cried, "Please wake up," but she never did.